

Backend Configuration & Data Setup – SLA Definition Configuration

SLA Definition Configuration

Overview

The **SLA Definition** is a core component of the **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System**. It defines how ServiceNow measures the time available to resolve an incident, the conditions under which the SLA starts and stops, and the business schedule used for time calculations.

In this project, a custom SLA named **Incident Resolution – Virtual Agent Governance** is created. This SLA automatically attaches to Incident records and tracks the resolution time based on the configured **IT Support Business Hours** schedule. The SLA forms the foundation for proactive monitoring, Flow Designer notifications, Virtual Agent interactions, reporting, and governance.

Objective

The objectives of configuring the SLA Definition are to:

- Define the Incident Resolution SLA.
 - Automatically attach the SLA to Incident records.
 - Measure incident resolution time accurately.
 - Use business hours for SLA calculations.
 - Enable proactive SLA monitoring and governance.
 - Support automated notifications and Virtual Agent workflows.
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Navigation

Navigate to the SLA Definition page using the following path:

Service Level Management → SLA Definitions

Click **New** to create a new SLA Definition.

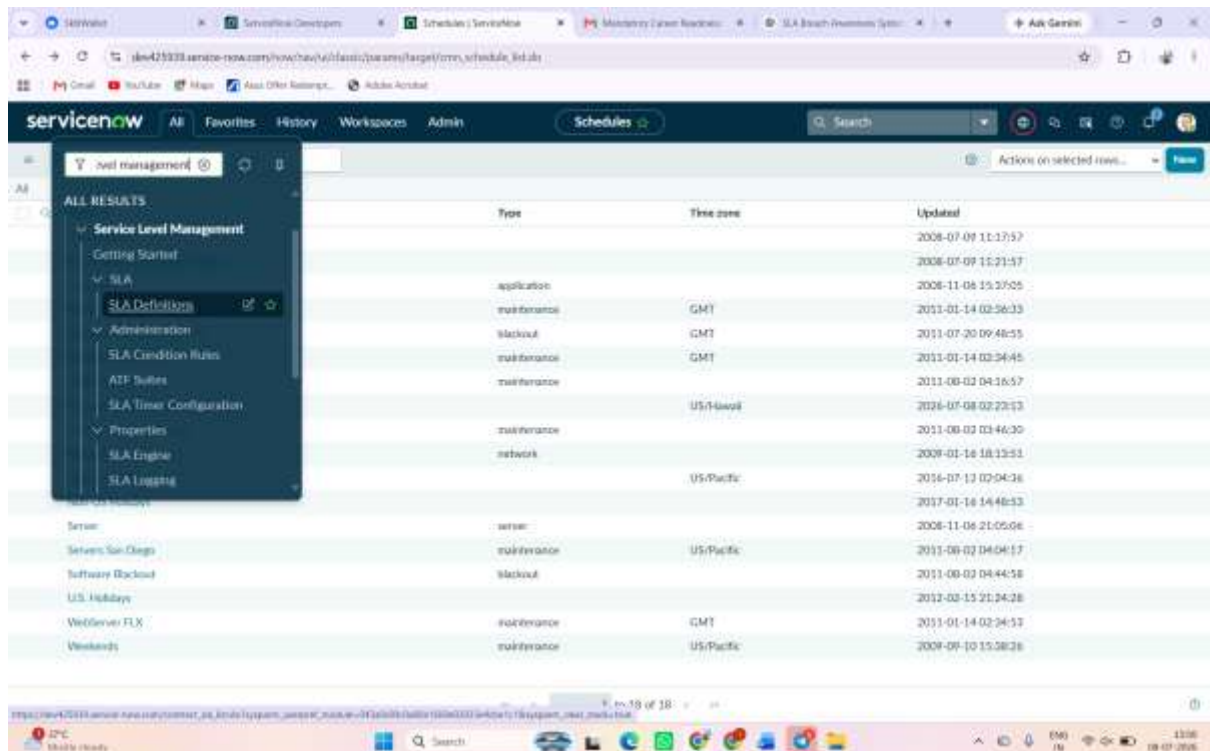
Step 1: Create a New SLA Definition

Enter the following details in the SLA Definition form.

Basic SLA Configuration

Field	Value
Name	Incident Resolution – Virtual Agent Governance
Table	Incident
Active	True
Type	SLA
Target	Resolution
Duration Type	User Specified
Duration	8 Hours
Schedule Source	SLA Definition
Schedule	IT Support Business Hours

After entering the required information, click **Submit** or **Save**.



Configuration Explanation

Name

Incident Resolution – Virtual Agent Governance uniquely identifies the SLA used to monitor Incident resolution within this project.

Table

The SLA is associated with the **Incident** table, ensuring that it applies only to Incident records.

Active

Setting **Active = True** enables the SLA so it can automatically attach to qualifying incidents.

Type

Selecting **SLA** specifies that this configuration measures compliance with a Service Level Agreement.

Target

The **Resolution** target indicates that the SLA measures the time taken to resolve an Incident.

Duration Type

User Specified allows the administrator to define a custom SLA duration.

Duration

The SLA duration is set to **8 Hours**, meaning incidents should be resolved within eight business hours.

Schedule Source

Choosing **SLA Definition** ensures the SLA uses the business schedule specified in this configuration.

Schedule

The **IT Support Business Hours** schedule calculates SLA time only during official working hours, excluding weekends and non-working periods.

Purpose of the SLA Definition

This configuration enables ServiceNow to:

- Automatically attach the SLA to Incident records.
 - Start the SLA timer when qualifying conditions are met.
 - Track elapsed and remaining business time.
 - Monitor SLA percentage completion.
 - Identify incidents approaching SLA breach.
 - Trigger Flow Designer notifications.
 - Support Virtual Agent conversations for SLA awareness.
 - Capture SLA governance information.
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Validation

After saving the SLA Definition, verify the following:

- The SLA Definition is **Active**.
- The **Incident** table is selected.
- The duration is set to **8 Hours**.
- The **IT Support Business Hours** schedule is associated correctly.
- The SLA automatically attaches to newly created Incident records.

- SLA timers calculate only during configured business hours.
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Expected Outcome

After completing the configuration:

- Every qualifying Incident automatically receives the **Incident Resolution – Virtual Agent Governance SLA**.
 - SLA tracking begins automatically.
 - Resolution time is calculated using business hours.
 - SLA progress is continuously monitored.
 - Incidents nearing SLA breach can trigger notifications and Virtual Agent interactions.
 - SLA data becomes available for reports, dashboards, and governance tracking.
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Benefits

- Standardized SLA management for all Incident records.
 - Accurate business-hour-based SLA calculations.
 - Automatic SLA attachment without manual intervention.
 - Foundation for proactive SLA monitoring and notifications.
 - Improved compliance with organizational service targets.
 - Enhanced accountability through SLA governance.
 - Reliable data for reporting, dashboards, and audits.
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Conclusion

The **SLA Definition Configuration** establishes the primary service level agreement for the **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System**. By defining an 8-hour Incident Resolution SLA and linking it to the **IT Support Business Hours** schedule, the system accurately monitors incident resolution performance. This configuration provides the foundation for automated monitoring, Flow Designer notifications, Virtual Agent guidance, reporting, and audit-ready SLA governance within the ServiceNow platform.

